

68.4 AGREEMENT AFTER "EITHER... OR" AND "NEITHER... NOR"

When "either... or" or "neither... nor" are used to join two nouns, the verb usually agrees with the second noun.

Either a tablet or a **laptop is** needed for the course.

The verb agrees with the second, singular noun.



Neither the teacher nor the **children were** happy.

The verb agrees with the second, plural noun.



If the second noun is singular and the first is plural, either a singular verb or a plural verb can be used.

Neither the **classrooms** nor the **office** { **has** / **have** } internet access.

The verb can be singular or plural.



FURTHER EXAMPLES

Either a loan or a **grant is** available for financial help.



I hope either sandwiches or **soup is** on the menu today.



Either my brother or my **grandparents are** coming.



Either pens or **pencils are** suitable to use in the exam.



Neither the swimming pool nor the **gym is** open on Sundays.



Neither a shirt nor a **tie is** compulsory at school.



Neither the bread nor the **cakes are** ready yet.



Neither calculators nor **study notes are** allowed in the exam.

